ill or medically unfit animals are not accepted.

The domestic price is ₹7,500 for a pet in the cabin. Between 10 kg and 32 kg, including the crate, the animal travels as checked baggage in an IATA-compliant hard kennel for ₹16,000. Above 32 kg, the booking moves to cargo.

Snub-nosed breeds, including Shih Tzus and pugs, are not accepted in the hold because of their greater respiratory risk. So they can travel on Air India only if they qualify for the cabin.

Internationally, Air India's in-cabin charges generally start at $140, with some sectors priced higher, while checked-baggage pets cost $350. Destination rules matter as much as airline rules, and travellers need to check both the carrier's policy and the entry regulations of the destination country. For instance, the UK does not allow pets in cabin, which becomes a particular problem if you have a snub-nosed dog as the carrier does not fly it in the hold!

Akasa's rules are similar. Cats and dogs must be at least three months old. Up to 10 kg, including the carrier, they may travel in the cabin; heavier animals can travel in the hold. Akasa permits up to three pets on a flight and offers pet travellers priority check-in, priority boarding, and a pre-booked window seat. Published fares are ₹7,500 for in-cabin travel and about ₹15,000





